

Website Project Proposal

Part 1: Concept and Site Map, CSCE 242

Website Name

MoneyWise

Description

MoneyWise is a personal website built to explore what I'm learning about money in one place, covering budgeting, investing, and automation. Rather than acting like a company or service, MoneyWise works more like a running personal knowledge base, digging into practical topics like comparing the 50/30/20 rule against other budgeting splits to help figure out what split actually fits a given income and set of goals, since no single split works for everyone, and using tools like Monarch Money to track spending. It also covers investing platforms such as M1 Finance for hands-off, automated portfolio management, along with retirement accounts like Roth IRAs and 401(k)s, including strategies such as the backdoor Roth conversion for people who earn too much to contribute directly. A recurring theme across the site is automation: setting up automatic transfers so that saving and investing happen every month without relying on willpower. The goal isn't to hand out polished financial advice from an expert, but to document real strategies, tools, and lessons in a way that's useful to revisit and easy for anyone else curious about personal finance to follow along with. Over time, the site will grow into a personal reference for the budgeting splits, account types, and automated systems that actually work.

Website Pages

- 1 **Home:** Intro to the site with a rotating slideshow highlighting recent and featured topics.
- 2 **Budgeting:** Comparing the 50/30/20 rule against other budgeting splits and how to find the split that actually fits your own income and goals, plus how tools like Monarch Money help track spending.
- 3 **Investing:** Breakdown of Roth IRAs, 401(k)s, and strategies like the backdoor Roth conversion, with comparisons of investing platforms.
- 4 **Automation:** How to set up automatic transfers and hands-off investing through tools like M1 Finance, with a screenshot gallery viewable in a lightbox.
- 5 **Tools & Resources:** A gallery of recommended apps and calculators (Monarch Money, M1 Finance, and more) with lightbox screenshots of each.
- 6 **About:** The story behind why the site exists, plus a validated newsletter signup form.